

# Milana Jade Berhe

📍 Berkeley, CA | [in](#) milana-berhe | ✉ milana.berhe@berkeley.edu

## EDUCATION

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### University of California, Berkeley

*Class of 2028*

*B.A. in Astrophysics, B.A. in Political Science, Minor in Creative Writing*

*GPA: 3.6/4.0*

- *Relevant Coursework:* Python for Astronomers, Calculus, Linear Algebra, Abstract Linear Algebra, Differential Equations, Classical Mechanics, Waves, Thermodynamics, Electricity and Magnetism, Optics, Relativity, Quantum Mechanics, International Relations, Comparative Government

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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### Student Researcher

Berkeley, CA

*Professor Wenbin Lu's High Energy Theoretical Astrophysics Group*

*June 2026 – Present*

- My goal is to create a functional and re-applicable model of gaseous, flared magnetar disks with Python to discover if accretion disks are indeed the cause of inconsistencies in observed spectral energy distributions
- Working under the guidance of graduate students Eliza Diggins and Savannah Cary and Professor Wenbin Lu

## TEACHING AND MENTORSHIP

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### Python for Astronomers DeCal Student Facilitator

Berkeley, CA

*UC Berkeley Department of Astronomy*

*July 2025 – Present*

- Presents material in lecture to class of roughly 70 students per semester
- Leads discussion and problem solving sessions in class
- Co-hosts weekly office hours to further problem-solve and deepen Python skills and knowledge

### Summer Undergraduate Mentor

Remote

*Mathematical & Physical Science Scholars*

*June 2026 – August 2026*

- Guiding 2 cohorts of 10 new students in 1-on-1 and group meetings, workshops, and community building events

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Managing Editor

Berkeley, CA

*UC Berkeley Student Affairs Communications*

*September 2024 – Present*

- Lead writer and interviewer for 20+ blog posts on the UC Berkeley Life Blog to convey the student experience at UC Berkeley
- Proofreads updates to the university website and school-wide communications in financial aid, events, housing, and undergraduate and graduate student information

## VOLUNTEER AND EXTRACURRICULAR EXPERIENCE

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### Community Development Officer

*Undergraduate Astronomy Society*

Berkeley, CA

*June 2026 – Present*

- Manages Cluster Mentorship Program consisting of 4 clusters, 15 mentors, and 100+ participants

### Marketing and Website Development Officer

*Undergraduate Astronomy Society*

Berkeley, CA

*August 2025 – May 2026*

- Developed and maintain the club website to organize events, resources, and photo archives
- Write and distribute a biweekly newsletter to 600+ subscribers, communicating club events and professional development opportunities
- Created and continuously updated the club website ([uasberkeley.github.io](https://uasberkeley.github.io))

### Telescope Crew Member

*Undergraduate Astronomy Society*

Berkeley, CA

*January 2025 – July 2025*

- Trained in the operation of Schmidt-Cassegrain, Newtonian, and Dobsonian telescopes
- Trained in the operation of UC Berkeley Astronomy's Richard Treffers 17" PlaneWave telescope

### Volunteer

*Discovery Cube Museum*

Orange County, CA

*June 2025 – Present*

- Expert in aerospace, rocketry, atmospheric science, planetary science, and physics
- Organized rotating constellation observation activity to 50+ visitors
- Sea life expert; 30+ hours behind tanks with sea stars, sharks, rays, sea snails, and anemones
- Expert in archaeology and dinosaur remains

### Contributing Editor

*Berkeley Poetry Review*

Berkeley, CA

*September 2024 – April 2026*

- Reads 40+ poems per week and contributes to discussions at weekly club meetings

### Lifestyle Writer

*The Daily Californian*

Berkeley, CA

*September 2025 – February 2026*

- Write 6+ how-tos, local guides, and quizzes for thousands of online readers per semester

### Designer and Writer

*NewSpace@Berkeley*

Berkeley, CA

*September 2024 – January 2025*

- Space consulting and policy club
- Wrote biweekly newsletters to send to club alumni, current members, and other subscribers
- Designed club merchandise and graphics
- Participated in the emergence of the space policy sector of the club

## AWARDS, PRESENTATIONS, AND PUBLICATIONS

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|------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026             | Majors and Minors Advice Panel, Undergraduate Astronomy Society |
| 2026             | Finalist, Brooke Owens Fellowship                               |
| 2024, 2025, 2026 | UC Berkeley Life Blog                                           |
| 2025             | The Daily Californian                                           |
| 2024             | Honorable Mention, National Scholastic Art and Writing Awards   |

## SKILLS

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|----------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Coding         | Python, Matplotlib, Pandas, SciPy, NumPy, LaTeX, HTML                                                                              |
| Digital Design | Google Suite, WordPress, Wix, Canva, Procreate                                                                                     |
| Languages      | English (native, fluent), Russian (native, fluent), Spanish (proficient), Japanese (limited)                                       |
| Art            | Printmaking, crochet, knitting, sketching, video editing (CapCut), photography, sewing, embroidery, guitar (electric and acoustic) |